

Muhammet Özkaraca

CONTACT INFORMATION	Department of Political Science	Website: muhammetozkaraca.github.io
	102 Emerson Drive, CB #3265	Email: ozkaraca@unc.edu
	UNC-Chapel Hill	
	Chapel Hill, NC 27599	
EDUCATION	University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill, USA	
	Ph.D., Political Science	2024 – Present
	M.A., Political Science	2026
	Central European University, Austria	
	M.A., Political Science	2021
	Bilkent University, Türkiye	
	B.A., International Relations	2020
	Minor: Political Science	
	Sciences Po Paris, France	
	Erasmus Exchange Student	2018
RESEARCH	Under Review	
	– “Blaming the Refs: Strategic Responses to Critical Election Reports” (with Tyler Pratt)	
	– “Free to Practice, Free from Terror: Freedom of Religion and Religious Terrorism”	
	Working Papers	
	– “Credit Among Regimes: Political Affinity in Sovereign Bilateral Lending”	
PRESENTATIONS & CONFERENCES	International Studies Association Annual Convention	2026
	Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference	2026
	American Political Science Association Annual Meeting	2026
	Behavioral Models of Politics Conference, Duke University	2026
	Sovereign Finance Lab, Princeton University	2026
	International Relations Brown Bag, UNC-Chapel Hill	2026
	Democratic Backsliding: Graduate Papers Workshop, Institute for Humane Studies	2026
	Methods and Design Workshop, UNC-Chapel Hill	2025
	IR Graduate Student Workshop, UNC-Chapel Hill	2025
TEACHING	Teaching Assistant	
	POLI 150: International Relations and Global Politics	F25, S26, F26
	Summer Ph.D. Math Camp	2025, 2026
FELLOWSHIPS & AWARDS	Graduate Student Transportation Grant, UNC-Chapel Hill (\$400)	2026
	APSA Travel Grant, American Political Science Association (\$200)	2026
	Summer Research Grant, UNC-Chapel Hill (\$3,500)	2026
	Student Travel Award, UNC-Chapel Hill (\$1,000)	2026
	Rapoport Summer Research Grant, UNC-Chapel Hill (\$3,000)	2025
	John McNeely DuBose Graduate Fellowship Fund, UNC-Chapel Hill (\$2,000)	2025
	Cobey Graduate Student Excellence Fund, UNC-Chapel Hill (\$1,000)	2025
	Full Tuition Waiver for Master in Transnational Governance, EUI [<i>declined</i>]	2021
	Master’s Scholarship, Central European University	2020–2021
	First Prize, Transdisciplinary Senior Project Competition, Bilkent University	2019
	Comprehensive Scholarship, Bilkent University	2015–2020
SERVICE	Methods and Design (MAD) Workshop Coordinator, UNC-Chapel Hill	2025–2026

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE	Research Assistant to Profs. Cameron Ballard-Rosa and Lucy Martin, UNC-CH	2025–2026
	Research Assistant to Prof. Frank Baumgartner, UNC-CH	2026
	Research Assistant, Istanbul Policy Center	2021
	Research Assistant to Prof. Berk Esen, Bilkent University	2019–2020
PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE	Project Assistant, International Centre for Migration Policy Development, Türkiye	2022–2024
	Intern, Center for Foreign Policy and Peace Research, Türkiye	2019
	Summer Intern, Issam Fares Institute, Lebanon	2018
ADDITIONAL TRAINING	University of Oslo & PRIO International Summer School, Norway	2021
	Peace Research	
	ECPR Summer School in Methods and Techniques, Hungary	2019
	R Basics	
	Qualitative Data Analysis	
	Longitudinal Research Designs: Qualitative Approaches	
SKILLS	Math Refresher	
	R (R Markdown, Quarto), $\LaTeX$, NVivo, MS Office (Excel, PowerPoint, Word)	
LANGUAGES	Turkish (native), English (fluent), French (intermediate)	